

A= Formulas

IN MATHS, A FORMULA IS BASICALLY A “RECIPE” FOR FINDING THE VALUE OF ONE THING (THE SUBJECT) WHEN OTHERS ARE KNOWN.

A formula usually has a single subject and an equals sign, together with an expression written in symbols that indicates how to find the subject.

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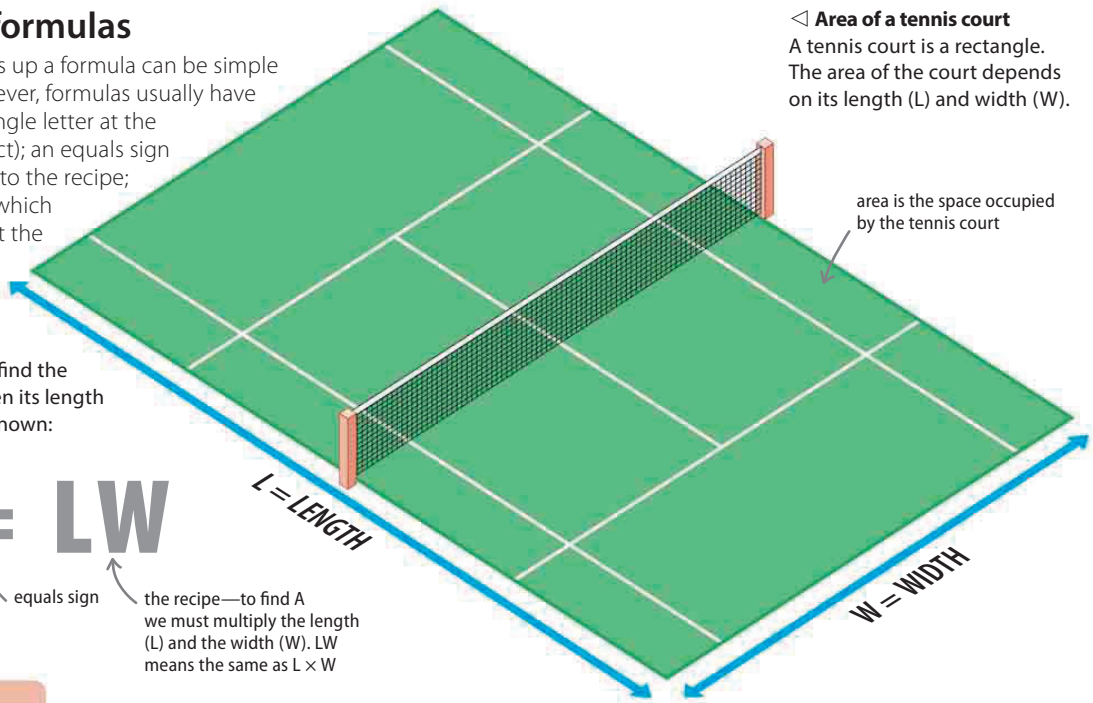
Introducing formulas

The recipe that makes up a formula can be simple or complicated. However, formulas usually have three basic parts: a single letter at the beginning (the subject); an equals sign that links the subject to the recipe; and the recipe itself, which when used, works out the value of the subject.

This is the formula to find the area of a rectangle when its length (L) and width (W) are known:

$$A = LW$$

subject of the formula equals sign the recipe—to find A we must multiply the length (L) and the width (W). LW means the same as $L \times W$

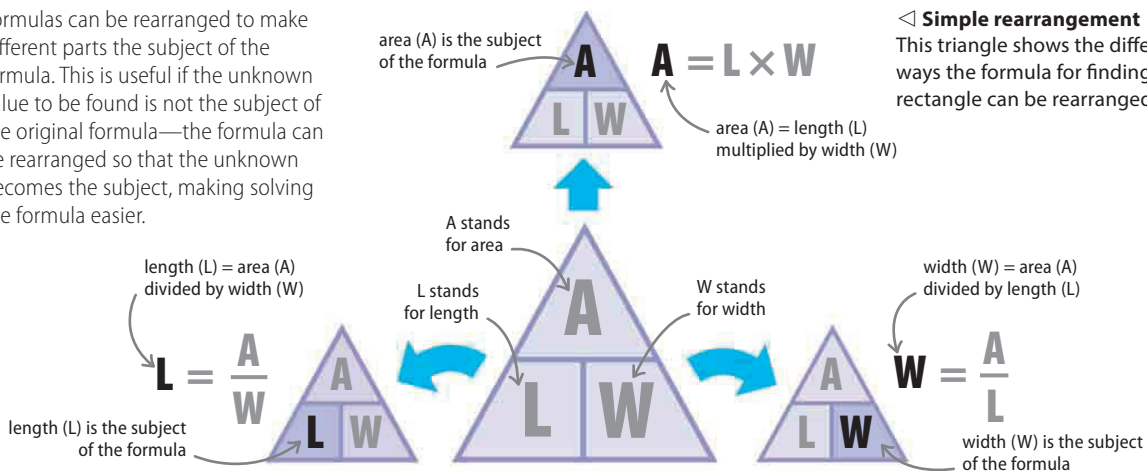


◁ **Area of a tennis court**
A tennis court is a rectangle. The area of the court depends on its length (L) and width (W).

LOOKING CLOSER

Formula triangles

Formulas can be rearranged to make different parts the subject of the formula. This is useful if the unknown value to be found is not the subject of the original formula—the formula can be rearranged so that the unknown becomes the subject, making solving the formula easier.



◁ **Simple rearrangement**
This triangle shows the different ways the formula for finding a rectangle can be rearranged.